“I'll always be the odd one out.”

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Where it often comes from

A lifetime of being the one who looks, moves, or sounds different can create the expectation that groups will never fully include us.

What Scripture teaches

“God settles the lonely in families.” “From Him the whole body, fitted and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love through the work of each individual part.” “Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good.” God’s family includes people of every kind, and the body needs your part. Some groups are not welcoming, but others are. You do not have to be the same to belong.

> *“Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good”* (1 Corinthians 12:7).

Also see

> “God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land” (Psalm 68:6).

> “From Him the whole body, fitted and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love through the work of each individual part” (Ephesians 4:16).

> “Just as each of us has one body with many members, and not all members have the same function, so in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another. We have different gifts according to the grace given us. If one’s gift is prophecy, let him use it in proportion to his faith” (Romans 12:4–6).

> “There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus” (Galatians 3:28).

Common self-statements

- I never fit.
- Everyone else matches.
- I will always stand out.
- I am the exception.
- Groups will always push me out.
- I will never belong.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I either fit perfectly or am an outsider.
- Fortune telling: Predicting permanent exclusion.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling different and concluding I do not belong.
- Overgeneralizing: Calling myself the odd one.

Challenging questions

- Where have I felt included, even once?
- What did those groups value?

- Where are others like me?
- What gift do I bring that others do not?
- What does Scripture say about the body?
- What group could I try?

Truth summary

> I belong to God's family, and the body needs me as I am. I can look for welcoming groups, bring my gifts, and make room for others who feel different.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Church
- Friendship
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Prejudice

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'll always be the odd one out"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll always be the odd one out." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where have I felt included, even once?
- ☐ What did those groups value?
- ☐ Where are others like me?
- ☐ What gift do I bring that others do not?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about the body?
- ☐ What group could I try?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God settles the lonely in families.
- ☐ Every part is needed.
- ☐ I have a gift for the common good.
- ☐ There is no division in Christ.
- ☐ Welcoming groups exist.
- ☐ I can make room for others.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:7
  "Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good."
- ☐ Psalm 68:6
  "God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land."
- ☐ Ephesians 4:16
  "From Him the whole body, fitted and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love through the work of each individual part."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Belonging: Each week, note one welcoming moment.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Corinthians 12:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Every part of the body is needed, including me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Recall belonging. Write where you felt included.
- [ ] Find your people. Seek groups with shared interests.
- [ ] Offer a gift. Contribute something small.
- [ ] Welcome another. Include someone who looks left out.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll always be the odd one out": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Belonging
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll always be the odd one out.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I feel like the odd one out. Place me in a family where I belong, use my gifts, and help me welcome others. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.